

Experience Concept

Define your proposed experience:

1. What focused brand experience or interaction are you designing for?

- I am designing a product discovery experience that transforms Heritage Bay's online retail browsing into a cultural storytelling journey. Through an interactive Trace Your Craft integration on the website. This allows consumers to explore and learn more about the meaning behind the designs, artisans and their craft process of each piece which allows consumers to better understand what makes each Heritage Bay product unique. After a product is purchased, as an extension of the experience, customers can join the Heritage Bay community to continue engaging with Heritage Bay and get exclusive updates and behind the scenes content which allows for post purchase engagement.

2. What problem or opportunity are you addressing?

- My experience addresses the challenge of communicating the value, meaning and craftsmanship behind Heritage Bay's products. While customers may be attracted to clothing based on their aesthetics or are interested to find out more, the cultural significance and artisan contributions behind each piece is barely communicated during the browsing experience on their website. As a result, customers may struggle to understand what makes one product unique from another other than the design and they are not able to emotionally connect with the brand. This presents an opportunity to transform retail browsing experience into a more engaging one that highlights Heritage Bay's commitment to culture, craftsmanship and contemporary design.

3. How does this align with Heritage Bay's brand?

- This aligns with Heritage Bay's brand as their core mission is to preserve culture with a modern twist, thus by integrating Trace Your Craft into the product discovery journey, it makes the designs, artisans and processes behind each piece more visible and accessible to customers. This helps Heritage Bay communicate the value of craftsmanship beyond aesthetics and helps to strengthen its brand positioning as a symbol of culture, craftsmanship and contemporary identity. The added community feature supports Heritage Bay's goal of engaging their target audience of youths by encouraging continued participation in local craft and cultural experiences beyond the point of purchase.

4. What insight or strategic perspective informs this approach?

- Website observations revealed that while Heritage Bay's products are visually appealing, the meaning, making process and cultural significance behind each piece are not apparent during the browsing experience. Although the website provides information about batik and the overall craft process in the About tab, it does not clearly communicate what makes each individual product meaningful or distinct in each individual product page. This results in consumers not being able to develop a deeper emotional connection with the brand.
- Additionally, while Heritage Bay aims to engage youths and young adults, opportunities for community participation are currently limited and not clearly communicated. This presents an opportunity to create a more engaging storytelling experience that not only highlights the people and processes behind each product but also encourages customers to build an ongoing relationship with the brand beyond the point of purchase.